DDD-P-56b
February 28, 1966
SUPERSEDING
Fed. Spec. DDD-P-56a
July 27, 1960

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PAD, MATTRESS, COTTON, QUILTED, WHITE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for a quilted cotton mattress pad.

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 *Type and sizes.* Mattress pads covered by this specification shall be of one type and two sizes, as specified (see 6.2).

Size 1—36 by 76 inches.
Size 2—52 by 75 inches.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

V-T-276—Thread, Cotton.
CCC-C-430—Cloth, Sheeting, Cotton.
CCC-T-191—Textile Test Methods.
DDD-L-20—Label; For Clothing, Equipage, and Tentage, (General Use).
PPP-B-636—Box, Fiberboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.
Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).
Fed. Std. No. 751—Stitches, Seams, and Stitchings.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, D. C. 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, D. C., Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, Wash.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specification:

MIL-B-43291—Boxes: Fiberboard; Corrugated, Double-Wall, Weather Resistant.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105—Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129—Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MS-16686—Medical Services Symbol.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

U. S. Department of Agriculture Publication SRA-180

Cotton and Cotton Linters Standards

(Application for copies should be addressed to the U. S. Department of Agriculture, Agricultural Marketing Service, Cotton Division, Washington 25, D. C.)

Rules and Regulations Under the Textile Fiber Products Identification Act.

(Copies may be obtained without charge from the Federal Trade Commission, Washington 25, D. C.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Guide sample. Guide samples, when furnished, are solely for guidance and information to the supplier (see 6.3). Variation from this specification may appear in the sample, in which case this specification shall govern.

3.2 Material.

3.2.1 *Linters.* The cotton linters shall be new (not previously used), not lower in grade than United States standard grade No. 3 and staple 3, conforming to the United States Department of Agriculture, Publication No. SRA-180.

3.2.2 *Felt.* The felt for the padding shall be made from 100 percent cotton linters conforming to 3.2.1. The felt shall be cleaned and garnetted so as to produce unbroken laminated sheets of interlaced garnetted felt and shall be trimmed on all four sides to produce an even thickness throughout the batting. To facilitate handling, a single ply of cellulosic wadding may be applied to the sheets of felt.

3.2.3 *Cloth.* The basic cloth for the cover of the mattress pads shall be seamless, bleached white, cotton sheeting conforming to type II, class 2, style B of CCC-C-430. The bias cut binding shall be made from the same material except the starch and protein content shall not exceed 8.0 percent.

3.2.4 *Thread, cotton.* The thread used for quilting and stitching the binding shall be bleached white cotton thread and shall conform to type IA2 of V-T-276. The thread for quilting shall be ticket No. 50, 3-ply. The thread for binding shall be ticket No. 30, 3-ply.

3.3 Labels. Each mattress pad shall have an identification label and a state label attached to one end of the pad.

3.3.1 *Identification label.* The identification label shall conform to type I, class 5 of DDD-L-20 except that the legend and size of characters shall be as specified below:

Legend	Size of character (minimum)
	Inch
Nomenclature	1/8
Contract number	3/32
Stock number	3/32
Textile Fiber Products Identification Act information	3/32

3.3.2 *State label.* The state label shall conform to the legal requirements of the state in which the mattress pads are manufactured.

3.3.3 *Medical label.* When specified (see 6.2), mattress pads procured for medical activities shall have added to the label specified in 3.3.1, a caduceus approximately one inch in height centered between the letters "U" and "S" of appropriate size conforming to type I of MS16686.

3.4 Size. The mattress pads shall measure not less than 36 inches in width and 76 inches in length for size 1 and 52 inches in width and 75 inches in length for size 2, when examined for dimensions as specified in 4.2.2.2.

3.5 Weight. The weight of the finished mattress pad shall be not less than 20

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ounces per square yard based in the finished size when tested as specified in 4.2.4.

3.6 Construction.

3.6.1 *Stitches, seams, and stitching.* Stitches, seams, and stitching types, as specified in table I, shall conform to Fed. Std. No. 751.

3.6.2 *Thread breaks and ends of seams.* Thread breaks and ends of all seams and stitching when not caught in other seams or stitching shall be backstitched or backtacked not less than 3/8 inch.

3.6.3 *Stitches per inch.* The minimum and maximum number of stitches per inch shall be as specified in table I.

TABLE I. *Manufacturing operations requirements*

No. Operations	Stitch type	Seam and stitching type	Stitches per inch	Thread	
				Needle	Bobbin or looper
1. *Cutting.*					
a. The cover shall be cut with no piecing seams on either face.					
b. The binding shall be cut on the bias, not less than 1-9/16 inches wide.					
c. The felt shall be trimmed on all four sides.					
2. *Quilting.*					
a. Position felt padding between two cover pieces.					
b. Quilting shall be accomplished with either zigzag or crisscross (diamond) stitching as specified below.	301	—	5-9	50-3	50-3
1) Zigzag. The horizontal distance between the parallel rows of stitches shall be 1 ± 1/16 inch. The length of the row of stitches in each direction before changing direction shall be 1-7/8 ± 1/8 inch (see fig. 1 (A)).					
2) Crisscross (diamond). The distance between the horizontal points shall be 2 ± 1/8 inch and the distance between the vertical points shall be 3-1/8 ± 1/8 inch, i.e.: the diamond, shaped by crisscross stitching, shall measure 2 ± 1/8 inch parallel to the filling direction of the fabric and 3-1/8 ± 1/8 inch in the warp direction of the fabric. The stitching forming the sides of the diamond shall be 1-7/8 ± 1/8 inch (see fig. 1 (B)).					
3. *Binding.*					
a. Bind the edges of the mattress pad with a continuous binding with the raw edges of the binding turned under and stitched 1/8 ± 1/16 inch from turned edge catching all raw edges in the stitching. The binding shall begin on the short side at a corner and continue around pad finishing not less than 12 inches beyond the starting end on the short side of pad.	301	BSc-1	6-10	30-3	30-3
b. The label or labels shall be centered on one end of the pad with the top or bottom edge caught in the binding seam. When two labels are used, they shall be positioned adjacent to each other.	301	BSc-1	6-10	30-3	30-3
4. Remove all spots and stains.					

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3.7 Manufacturing operations requirements. The mattress pads shall be manufactured in accordance with all operations specified in table I. The supplier is not required to follow the exact sequence of operations.

3.7.1 *Figure* 1. Figure 1 is furnished for information purposes only. To the extent of any inconsistencies between the written specification and the figure, the written specification shall govern.

3.8 Workmanship. The finished mattress pads shall conform to the quality and grade of product established by this specification. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the applicable acceptable quality levels (AQLs).

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Inspection. Inspection shall be in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated herein.

4.2.1 *Inspection of components and materials.* The quality assurance provisions for components and materials, except as otherwise required by this specification, shall be in accordance with applicable specifications and standards referenced herein.

4.2.1.1 *Testing of components.* Testing shall be performed on the components listed in table III. The sample unit for the linters shall be 1/2 pound. The sample unit for the garnetted felt shall be 12 by 12 inches. The sample size shall be as specified in table II and the lot shall be unacceptable if one or more units fail to meet any requirement specified.

TABLE II

Lot size	Sample size
800 or less	2
801 up to and including 22,000	3
22,001 and over	5

TABLE III. *Component tests*

Component and lot expressed in terms of	Characteristic	Requirement reference	Test method
Linters (1 bale)	Grade	3.2.1	Visual[1]
Garnetted felt (100 pounds)	Quality	3.2.2	Visual[1]

[1] One determination per sample unit and the results reported as pass or fail.

Note: Samples of cotton linters shall not be sent to the Government laboratory for grading if the linters have been officially graded by the United States Department of Agriculture. The inspector shall obtain from the supplier a certificate or an attested or photostatic copy of the certificate showing the number of bales, the number or identifying mark on each bale graded, and the identity of the grades when United States Department of Agriculture graded supplier furnished material is used. Whenever supplier furnished cotton linters have not been graded by a properly qualified employee of the Government or a Government licensed classifier, the sample of linters shall be sent to the Government laboratory for grading. Grading by any other than Government employed graders or Government licensed classifiers shall not be acceptable.

4.2.1.2 *In-process inspection.* Inspection shall be made at any point or during any phase of the manufacturing process to determine whether operations or assemblies are accomplished as specified. The Government reserves the right to exclude from consideration for acceptance any material or service for which in-process inspection has indicated nonconformance.

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4.2.2 *Examination of the end item.* Defects found during this examination shall be classified in accordance with the lists shown in 4.2.2.1 and 4.2.2.2. The sample unit for these examinations shall be one finished mattress pad. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one finished mattress pad. The inspection levels and AQLs for these examinations shall be in accordance with 4.2.2.3.

4.2.2.1 *Visual examination.* The finished mattress pad shall be visually examined for defects listed in table IV.

TABLE IV. *Classification of defects*

Examine	Defects	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Material defects (sheeting)	Any hole, cut, tear, or weak place:		
	—Seriously affecting serviceability	X	
	—Affecting serviceability but not seriously		X
	Objectionable or rancid odor	X	
	Fabric not as specified	X	
	Three or more contiguous broken or missing warp or filling threads ...	X	
	Two continguous broken or missing warp or filling threads		X
	Loose or weakening slub		X
Cleanness	Any spot or stain, attributable to the sheeting material only, more than 1/4 inch square in area, clearly noticeable at a distance of 6 feet		X
	More than three spots or stains attributable to the sheeting material only, up to 1/4 inch square in area, clearly noticeable at a distance of 6 feet		X
Cleanness (cont'd)	Any oil or grease spot or stain attributable to the padding	X	
	Any colored or dyed yarns attributable to the padding ...	X	
Workmanship	Any thin place devoid of padding 2 inches square or more in area	X	
	Any thin place devoid of padding, more than one inch square in area, but less than 2 inches square in area ...		X
	Three or more thin places devoid of padding regardless of area	X	
	Furrow, lump, or bulge resulting from uneven or improper distribution of the padding ... (Lapped padding is not considered improper distribution)	X	
	More than four untrimmed thread ends or loose threads, one inch or more in length .		X
	Edges badly twisted, pleated, wavy, or puckered		X
	Three or more pleats less than 8 inches in length and 1/4 inch or more in depth at widest point regardless of area per pad	X	
	Any pleat regardless of area, 8 inches or more in length and 1/4 inch or more in depth at widest point, or any pleat not within 5 inches from any edge ex-		

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TABLE IV. *Classification of defects (cont'd)*

Examine	Defects	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Workmanship (cont'd)	tending more than 2 inches in length .	X	
	Any splice in sheeting fabric	X	
	Needle chews expected to develop into a hole	X	
Binding	Not cut in bias direction	X	
	Torn or chewed ...	X	
	Not one continuous length per pad ...		X
	Closing end extends less than 12 inches beyond the starting end		X
	Binding not securely caught in binding seam		X
Seams and stitching	Binding not seamed with seam type BSc-1		X
	Not stitch type 301 throughout		X
	Stitching margin of binding less than 1/16 inch or more than 3/16 inch ...		X
	Binding seam does not begin at corner on short side of pad		X
	Binding sewn with less than 6 stitches per inch		X
	Binding sewn with more than 10 stitches per inch ..		X
	Any open seam or runoff more than 1 inch in length	X	
	Any open seam or runoff 1 inch or less in length		X
	Edge of pad not securely caught in binding		X
	Any raw edge of binding more than 1/2 inch in length .		X
	Three or more raw edges of binding		
Seams and stitching (cont'd)	per pad up to and including 1/2 inch in length		X
	Raw edge of pad covering, over 2 inches in length ..		X
	Two or more raw edges of pad covering, up to and including 2 inches in length		X
	Any raw edge of the pad covering regardless of length, not caught in binding stitching	X	
	Note. This examination shall be made by turning back the edge of the binding at the raw edge locale and determining visually whether the pad covering is caught in the binding stitches.		
	Stitch tension loose, resulting in a loosely secured seam or looped stitches ...		X
	Stitch tension tight, stitches break when normal strain is applied to the seam or stitching		X
	Note. Puckering is evidence of tight tension.		
	Thread breaks or ends of any seam (except on quilting) not backstitched as specified, except when end of seam is caught in another seam or stitching .		X
	One or more broken stitches at four or more places in quilting		X
	Continuous skipped stitches for a distance of 1 inch or		

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Examine	Defect	Classification	
		Major	Minor
Seams and stitching (cont'd)	more at two or more places in quilting		X
	Quilting dimensions not in accordance with table I		X
	Less than 5 stitches per inch in quilting		X
	More than 9 stitches per inch in quilting		X
Labels	Missing, misplaced, text incomplete, incorrect, or illegible		X

4.2.2.2 *Examination for dimensions.* Each mattress pad examined for dimensions, shall be laid in a flat position without tension. The length and width shall be the average of three measurements taken in each direction. Any average less than the length or width specified, for the size required, shall be classified as a defect.

4.2.2.3 *Inspection level and AQL.* The inspection levels and AQL expressed in defects per 100 units shall be as follows:

Examination	Inspection level	AQL	
		Major	Total (major & minor)
4.2.2.1	II	4.0	10.0
4.2.2.2	S-3	—(1 class)	4.0

4.2.3 *Examination of preparation for delivery requirements.* An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing and marking requirements of section 5 are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table V. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 2.5 defects per hundred units.

TABLE V. *Classification of preparation for delivery defects*

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing. Any component damaged, affecting serviceability.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as incomplete closure of container flaps, improper taping, loose strapping, inadequate stapling or bulging, or distortion of containers. Polyethylene bags heat sealed seams open, noncontinuous or crooked; vent hole missing or greater than 1/4-inch diameter.
Content	Number per container is more or less than required.

4.2.4 *Testing of the end item.* The weight of the mattress pad shall be determined on pads in equilibrium under standard conditions as defined in CCC-T-191. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one pad each. The sample unit shall be one finished pad. The sample size shall be as specified in table II. The weight per square yard of the pad shall be determined by weighing one complete pad to the nearest ounce and calculating by the following formula:

$$\text{Ounces per square yard} = \frac{\text{Weight of pad in ounces} \times 36 \times 36}{\text{Length in inches} \times \text{Width in inches.}}$$

The lot shall be unacceptable if any pad fails to meet the requirement specified in 3.5.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

For civil agency procurement, the definitions and application of levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 102.

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5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 *Level A.* Each pad shall be neatly folded to measure approximately 18 by 25 inches. The folded pad shall then be packaged in a close-fitting flat or square style clear polyethylene film bag of 0.00125-inch thickness (plus or minus 20 percent tolerance). The polyethylene bag shall be formed with heat sealed seams that are straight and continuous and parallel to each other and the formed edges of the bag. A 1/4-inch maximum diameter hole shall be made at one corner of each polyethylene bag to allow the excess air to escape. The bag shall be closed by means of a heat seal or pressure sensitive tape. Prior to or during the closure operation, excess air within the bag shall be expelled (see 6.5).

5.1.2 *Level C.* Each pad shall be packaged to afford adequate protection against damage during shipment from the supply source to the first receiving activity. The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets this requirement.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 *Level A.* Eighteen size 1 or twelve size 2 pads, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style OSC-L (minimum 3-inch overlap), V3c or V3s of PPP-B-636. The inside of each PPP-B-636 shipping container shall be fitted with a taped liner conforming to class domestic, variety SW, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The box liner may be untaped and have its ends abut at the opposite corner from the manufacturer's joint. Alternatively, shipping containers shall conform to style OSC, V13c of MIL-B-43291. Level A packages shall be packed flat, eighteen size 1 or twelve size 2 in depth within a shipping container. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 25-1/2 inches in length, 18-1/2 inches in width, and 18-1/2 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each container shall be waterproofed in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636. Each shipping container shall be closed and reinforced with flat steel strapping or tape banding in accordance with the appendix of the applicable container specification.

5.2.2 *Level B.* Eighteen size 1 or twelve size 2 pads, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a fiberboard shipping container conforming to style OSC-L (minimum 3-inch overlap), type CF or SF, class domestic, variety SW, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The inside of each shipping container shall be fitted with a taped liner conforming to class domestic, variety SW, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. The box liner may be untaped and have its ends abut at the opposite corner from the manufacturer's joint. Level A packages shall be packed flat, eighteen size 1 or twelve size 2 in depth within a shipping container. Inside dimensions of each shipping container shall approximate 25-1/2 inches in length, 18-1/2 inches in width, and 18-1/2 inches in depth. Approximate dimensions are furnished as a guide only. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method II in the appendix of the container specification.

5.2.2.1 When specified, shipping containers shall be fabricated from V3c or V3s fiberboard (see 6.2).

5.2.3 *Level C.* Pads, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed in a manner to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery at destination at the lowest transportation rate for such supplies. Containers shall be in accordance with rules or regulations of carriers applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

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5.3.2 *Military requirements.* In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.3.2.1 *Polyethylene bagged packages.* Polyethylene bagged packages shall have the required information legibly printed or stamped in black directly on the bag across the center face or on a white paper label inserted within the bag so as to permit ready identification. The bag or label shall indicate the following information:

STOCK NUMBER
NOMENCLATURE
QUANTITY

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The mattress pads are intended for use on beds for the protection of mattresses, by military and nonmilitary agencies.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(*b*) Size required (see 1.2.1).
(*c*) Whether medical label is required (see 3.3.3).
(*d*) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(*e*) Whether V-board shipping containers are required for level B shipments (see 5.2.2.1).

6.3 Guide sample. For access to guide samples, address the procuring office issuing the invitation for bids.

6.4 When level B packaging requirements are specified for civil agency procurements, the requirements in 5.1.1 shall apply.

6.5 The method of packaging referred to in 5.1.1 is similar to method III of MIL-P-116, Preservation, Methods of.

6.6 Transportation descriptions. The transportation descriptions and minimum weights applicable to this commodity are:

Rail:

Pads, cotton, not otherwise indexed by name, quilted.
Carload minimum weight 20,000 pounds, subject to Rule 34, Uniform Freight Classification.

Motor:

Pads, cotton, not otherwise indexed, quilted.
Truckload minimum weight 20,000 pounds, subject to Rule 115, National Motor Freight Classification.

CUSTODIANS:

Army—GL
Navy—SA
Air Force—67

Review activities:

Navy—SA, MC
Air Force—67

User activities:

Army—SM, MD
Navy—MS

Preparing activity:

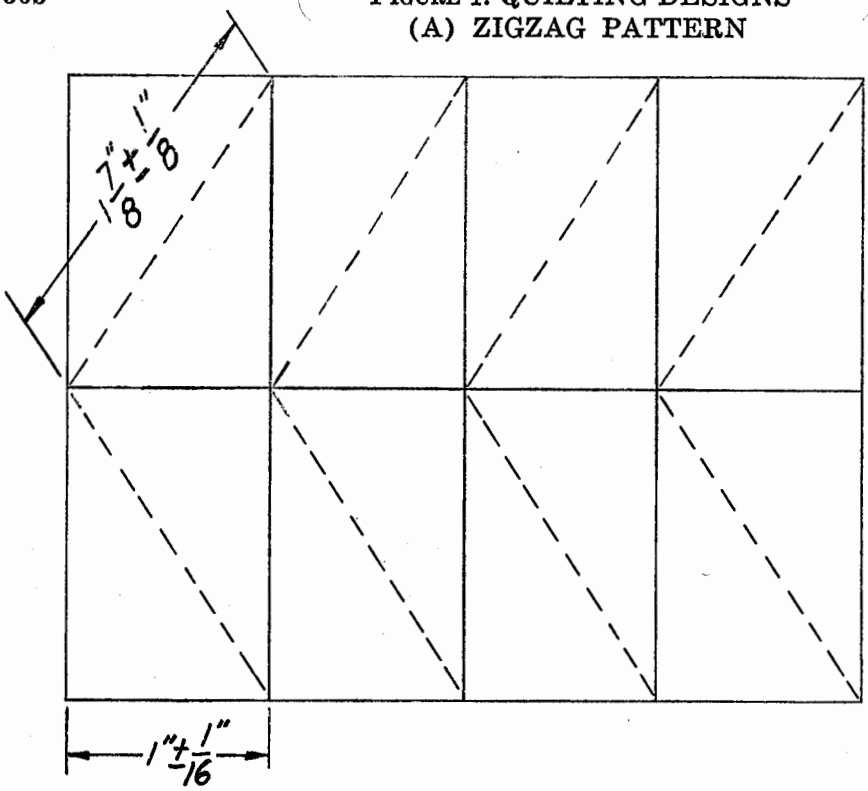
Army—GL

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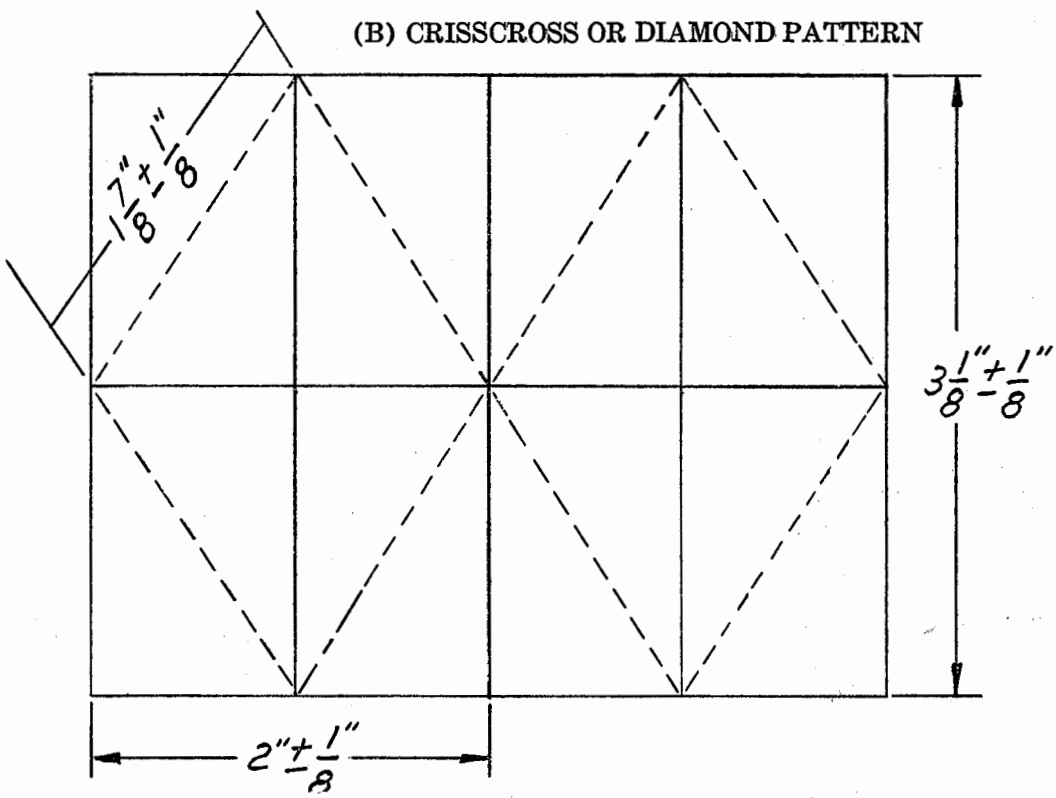
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FIGURE 1. QUILTING DESIGNS

(A) ZIGZAG PATTERN



(B) CRISSCROSS OR DIAMOND PATTERN



this specification to

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